

Julien Crésus-Ashton

SENIOR INTERACTION DESIGNER

Paris-born, London-based interaction designer. I work mainly in government, designing services for HMRC, DEFRA and the Ministry of Defence, where the people using what you build often have no choice but to use it. I care about accessibility as a baseline, not a box to tick. I also work well across research, product and development, and am comfortable moving between different kinds of teams.

EXPERIENCE

Cognizant

Senior Interaction Designer

Nov 2023 – Present

- Owned interaction design for HMRC's Welsh Council Tax service, turning complex policy into accessible, GDS-compliant prototypes that users could actually navigate.
- Worked closely with researchers through usability testing, using findings to refine designs and improve task completion rates.
- Set out personas, interaction models and service flows to GDS standards; made WCAG 2.2 compliance a baseline expectation across the team, not an afterthought.
- Contributed design direction to DEFRA and Natural England projects, working across design, research and development to keep things joined up.

DAM Digital

Senior UX/UI Designer

Apr 2022 – Nov 2023

- Led UX strategy across a range of clients including McArthurGlen and Crisis, making sure design decisions were grounded in user needs without losing sight of business goals.
- Ran the full design process in Figma, Miro and Whimsical, from early discovery through to handoff, working directly with PMs and developers throughout.
- Kept accessibility and design system standards consistent across projects, and managed client relationships through regular reviews and feedback sessions.

Methods

UX Designer

Feb 2019 – Apr 2022

- Designed for government programmes including Every Mind Matters, National Funding Formula and Ministry of Defence initiatives, working to GDS standards throughout.
- Built prototypes in Figma based on real user research; produced personas, user journeys and service maps to help teams understand where designs needed to go.
- Ran workshops that brought research, product and development into the same room, helping bridge the gap between what was designed and what got built.

Société Générale Design

UX/UI Designer Trainee

Sep 2017 – Dec 2018

- Designed across a range of projects from trading platforms to internal innovation programmes, working in both low- and high-fidelity using Adobe XD and Sketch.
- Ran co-creation sessions with product owners, end users and IT teams to shape concepts early.

SKILLS

Interaction Design
UX & Service Design
Prototyping
Wireframing
User Research
GDS Design System
WCAG 2.2
Journey Mapping
Workshop Facilitation
Agile / Scrum
HTML & CSS
JavaScript

TOOLS

Figma · Sketch · Adobe Suite
Miro · Whimsical
JIRA · Confluence

EDUCATION

MSc UX Design

Kingston University, London
2018

Thesis: Autism awareness app in WebVR

BA Web Design

Epitech Digital · Paris · 2016

LANGUAGES

French — Native
English — Bilingual
German — Basic